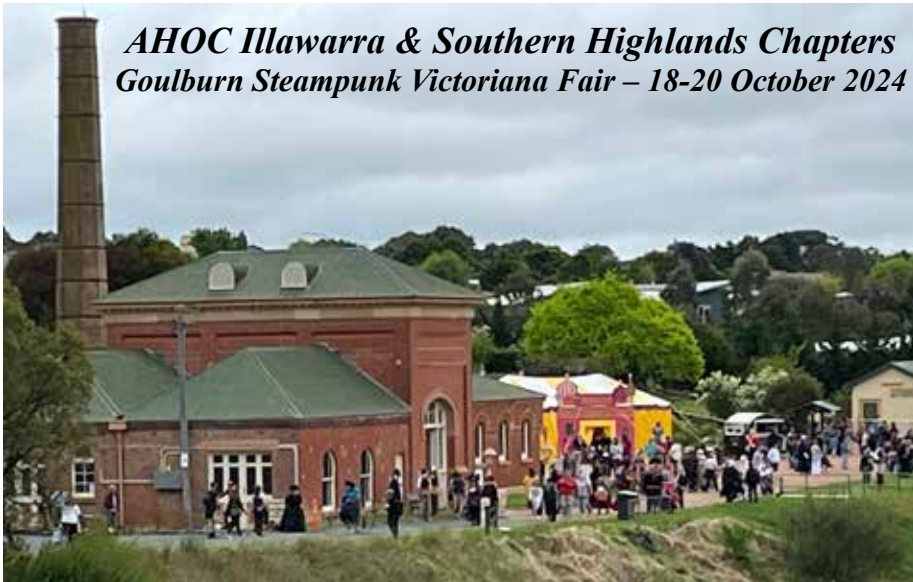




FLAT CHAT NEWSLETTER
AUSTIN-HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
ABN: 87 630 303 136

***AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters
Goulburn Steampunk Victoriana Fair – 18-20 October 2024***



How does our Austin-Healey Owners Club chapter end up spending a weekend away attending a “Steampunk Victoriana Fair”?

Well, the story started 12 months earlier while I was having a discussion with Joe Armour about future activities. Joe mentioned he had heard of a historic steam, single arm pump located in Goulburn and that it would be a great event for our chapters.

I opened the web to investigate and found a host of information

on the Historic Waterworks in Goulburn.

There was additional information on the web site promoting the annual Steampunk Victoriana Fair that is held in conjunction with an open day at the Waterworks each year. After reading it, I was convinced this was an ideal venue for an Austin-Healey event.

A description: Steampunk mixes the industrial age with futuristic imaginations or how the future

Cont’ P11



Design by Amy Q Design

VOL. 11 ISSUE **#11**
Nov 2024

COMING EVENTS

NOVEMBER

2nd Cent Coast Gathering
7th Monthly Meeting
10th Zig Zag Railway
13th Committee Meeting
20th Illawarra & Sth H'lands
Lunch

DECEMBER

1st Sydney Car Talk
5th AGM & Monthly Meet
7th Central Coast Gathering
11th Committee Meeting
15th Mid-Nth Coast Gather

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POST: AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 3011
Rhodes NSW 2138

EMAIL: enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au
WEB: www.austinhealeynsw.com.au
FB: www.facebook.com/groups/681723625314952/

Our monthly meetings are held at Strathfield Golf Club, 52 Weeroona Rd, Strathfield NSW 2135 on the 1st Thursday of each month commencing at 7.30pm.

Members and guests are welcome to join us for dinner in the bistro from 5.30pm.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Not a great amount to report on this month as I have been spending a fair amount of time in Flowerpot, Tasmania getting my father-in-law's property ready for sale, now that he is in a nursing home. This has been, and will continue to be, for the next weeks and months a huge job, as living on five acres with a huge shed that normally I would be envious of, was needing to be decluttered. This man has thrown nothing, and I mean nothing, out in for most of his 95 years and Vinnies, the recycling shop and the "waste transfer station" (that's a euphemism for garbage dump) have received many carloads of contributions.

However back to things of relevance.

The **Annual General Meeting** will be held prior to the general meeting in December. You will find the formal notification of this event in this issue of Flat Chat so that we comply with the rules and regulations. This is the meeting when we consider the annual reports and elect the committee to



manage your club through 2025. The notion attributed to comedian Lucille Ball "that If you want something done, ask a busy person if you want anything done, ask a busy man. If you want work well done, ask a busy woman" and this sums up those on your committee. Most have been in their roles for many years and that is appreciated, but as a club, we need to be thinking about our future direction and involving many of our "younger" members that don't come to our meetings to start getting involved, even by offering to assist committee members and to thereby influence the future directions of our club.

For 2025 our secretary Julie, who put her hand up for the role many years ago when no one else volunteered and we were considering hiring someone, is looking for an alternative role. Please consider if you are able to fill this very important role in our club. We don't necessarily need the role to be "well done" as it currently is, just "done" is all that's required. Nomination forms for this and all the other roles will be available at the November meeting and will be included with the copy of reports to be sent to you prior to the meeting.

Cont Page 7

COMMITTEE LIST - 2024

Club Patron—Ross Bond

President - Jim Phillips
8 Belina Ave.,
Wyoming NSW 2250
0413 589 306
jjimbeau@gmail.com

Vice-President - Geoff Smith
0458 777 339
m.gpsmith@bigpond.com

Secretary - Julie Lee
0421 598 755
hedli@tpg.com.au

Treasurer - Jenny Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Social Secretary - Dianne Lawlor
0413 873 191
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Editor - Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Rd.,
Kurrajong Heights 2758
0417 673 065
p.cquinn@outlook.com

Historian - Joe Armour
0419 233 099
joea6@bigpond.com

Membership Secretary - Christine Lyttle
0410 201 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Regalia - Colin Rule
0467 563 523
coolibahconvertible@bigpond.com

Technical Officer - Greg Strange
02 9319 2299
gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Club Registrar - Patrick Quinn
(Inc Conditional Registration)
Please send all Conditional Registration documents to Patrick's postal address at left

Public Relations - Ross Penman
0408 465 547
penmans@bigpond.com

Webmaster - Jim Phillips
0413 589 306
jjimbeau@gmail.com

Public Officer - Alan Mitchell
PO Box 123
Marulan 2579
0412 898 656
mitchellaj@ozemail.com.au

Non-Committee Positions

Chapter Coordinators		
Central Coast	Colin Rule	0467 563 523
Illawarra/Sth H'lands	John Thornton	0419 266 284
Mid Nth Coast	Phil Loking	0412 392 362
Western	Greg Poole	(02) 5355 0079

CSCA Delegate - Colin Goldsmith

Librarian - Ronnie Strange

CMC Delegates - Ray Roberts
Greg Strange

Welfare Officer - Pamela Ross 0408 201 226

Display Day Coordinators - Ross & Jenny Penman

Conditional Registration Inspectors -
Neville Stirton - 0414 472 877 - Geoff Smith - 0458 777 339 - Phil Loking - 0412 392 362

Assn of British Car Clubs Rep - Christine Lyttle

National Assn Delegates - Gordon Lynas & Jim Phillips

AHOC Life Members - Don Read (D), Alan Jones (D),
Warwick Sell (D), Joe Armour, Christine Lyttle, Patrick
Quinn, Terry Bancroft (D), Ray Roberts and David Mould.

If you want to send something by post, the Club's
address is:- AHOC (NSW) Inc
PO Box 3011
Rhodes NSW 2138

It would be appreciated if there were no phone calls to committee members after 9:00 PM.

EXHAUST LEAKS



Greetings and welcome to the November 2024 issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter.

October has been a quieter month than the last, meaning that I haven't been really busy on Austin-Healey related things. However that's just me, as the AHOC chapters have been running to form with their drawcard events.

On the cover you will find John Thornton's report of the Illawarra and Southern Highlands chapters' visit to the Goulburn's Steampunk Victoriana Fair. Further within the issue there are reports on the chapter events on the Central Coast and the mid-north coast. In addition, on page 10 there is a short report on the visit to the Australian Botanic Garden at Mount Annan.

While we have the reports, I can't say that the events attracted a huge number of members. Why is it so? Frankly, I don't know. While our membership numbers continue to grow, there is a dearth of members attending events.

What else is in this issue?

If you're interested in the 2025 National Rally in Victoria, you will find the booking forms and so forth starting on page 16. If perhaps the Rally attracts, but the thought of blasting south on the Hume Highway does not, Gordon Lynas is putting together a slow tour along the coast. You can read about that on page 24.

It's interesting what can be picked up online. Just a few days back I received an email from Hagertys, a US/UK specialist vehicle insurer. It's all about a bloke setting into the Californian hinterland in a well-used 100/6. I enjoyed it and I hope you do as well. Thanks to <https://www.hagerty.com/> Yes there are other bits and pieces that I hope you will all enjoy, such as committee reports and never forgetting the minutes.

As to the Quinn Austin-Healey, last month I made mention that I thought the generator wasn't pulling its weight. The car is fitted with an ammeter which swings backwards and forwards in way that doesn't really tell me much except that there isn't enough volts, amps or thingies being made that were worthwhile. So I sent the regulator away for servicing and a good thing too. The dual points were adjusted and filed, while the regulator was treated with a bit of spit and polish and the connection screws wire brushed.

Refitting should be the easiest

thing thinkable, but the captive nuts on the other side of the firewall have long since escaped. This results in lots of fun for two, with a screwdriver and small spanner.

The result? Excellent, as the ammeter needle now spends more time in the positive. However one thing I have noticed is how strong it swings to the negative when overdrive is first selected. I'm pleased to say that the needle does behave itself after a few minutes and hovers just in the positive. I'm told this is normal.

Oh yes! The inline fuse for the power pickup that thinks it's negative, but is really positive, has been replaced and so far so good.

I trust you enjoy this issue of the Flat Chat Newsletter, and as usual I am looking forward to receiving lots of words and photos of what you have been up to with your Austin-Healeys



Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**

Minutes of the General Meeting

Thursday, 3 October 2024

Meeting commenced at 7:40pm.

Venue - Strahfield Golf Club and via Zoom

ATTENDEES

Joe & Lenore Armour, Patricia Bancroft, Jeff Burton, Colin Goldsmith, George & Liz Goodare, Chris Hatch (Z), Richard Horwood, Denis Kasza, Dianne Lawlor, Garry & Julie Lee, Peter Laurantus, Gordon & Louise Lynas, Christine Lyttle, Alan Mitchell, Jim Phillips (Chair), Patrick Quinn (Z), Rod Richards, Muriel & Ray Roberts, Colin Rule, John & Judy Sherman, Greg Strange, Ronnie Strange, Mark Sullivan, Allan Whitehouse

VISITORS, NEW MEMBERS

N/A

APOLOGIES

Gabi & Mark Bancroft, John & Kate Burch, Natalie & Vince Cessario, Bryan Levy, Neville Stirton, John Thornton, David Williamson, Caroline Quinn.

MINUTES

Resolved that the minutes of the General Meeting held 5 September 2024, as published in the October 2024 issue of *Flat Chat*, be verified as a correct record of that meeting.

PRESIDENT'S REPORT

Jim updated everyone on the impact of the changed catering/room hire arrangements at Strathfield Golf Club, which had seen many car clubs leave for other venues. The good news was that he'd been able to get a stay of execution to the end of 2024 under our previous arrangements. He asked everyone to scout out any possible meeting locations and to let the Committee know if they found somewhere likely.

The other big news was that the AGM would be held on the night of the December meeting. As always, there was a dire need for volunteers, so he encouraged members to put their hands up.

VICE-PRESIDENT'S REPORT

No report

SECRETARY'S REPORT

Apart from the usual smorgasbord of car club magazines received, Julie advised that the only other email of interest was from the CMC, seeking information

from clubs on when and where they held their meetings, and how many attended. She hoped that this information would be made available once finalised.

TREASURER'S REPORT

In Jenny's absence, Jim reported on the Club's kitty as at 30 September 2024:

Term Deposit \$110,000.00

Cash Reserve \$2,585.47

Debit Card \$303.82

Main Account \$19,762.36

Total \$132,651.65

In addition, the Charlie's Run account had a balance of \$2,486.22.

Income

Bank Account Interest \$00.02

Membership \$750.00

All British Day Tickets \$50.00

Expenses

Name Badges \$48.00

Flat Chat Software \$89.97

Postage \$11.32

Social (Gathering of the Clans) \$147.10

MEMBERSHIP SECRETARY'S REPORT

A new member for the month was Glenn Nisbet, from Nerong.

SOCIAL SECRETARY'S REPORT

Fearless Social Sec Dianne gave everyone the skinny on the Mt Annan Botanical Gardens tour and Zig Zag Heritage Railway trip, amongst other events. She bemoaned how difficult it was to get lunch bookings for large groups, with venues increasingly wanting non-refundable deposits.

Dianne also mentioned a movie available on SBS "A Great Friend" as great viewing with the added bonus of featuring a Austin-Healey!



WEBMASTER'S REPORT

Not much to report.

WELFARE OFFICER'S REPORT

Pamela had sent a get well card to Natalie Cessario

EDITOR'S REPORT

Patrick thanked Jim for assisting with the rather late in the evening send out of *Flat Chat*.

REGISTRAR'S REPORT

Apparently it had been a bit quiet lately.

HISTORIAN

Joe had a range of Austin-Healey related stories to share.

LIBRARIAN

Nothing to report.

TECHNICAL OFFICER

Greg suggested doing another workshop on multi-meters (following the recent Central Coast workshop on the same topic) as he knew a lot of people bought them then, didn't know quite what to do with them!

PUBLIC RELATIONS REPORT

No Report.

CMC REPORT

Greg reported on the most recent CMC meeting:

- A lot of car clubs were going elsewhere with Strathfield Golf Club's steep increase in costs
- The Minister had attended a recent road safety day which was a bit unusual
- National Motoring Heritage Day was scheduled for 18 May 2025
- Clubs can now decide for themselves which options and accessories fit within historic registration
- Fitting of seatbelts and seatbelt cameras were still a work in progress.

ASSOC. OF BRITISH CAR CLUBS REPORT

The next meeting was scheduled for the following week.

CSCA REPORT

The TSOA had decided to hold their November SuperSprint at Luddenham Raceway, which was a 1.5km privately owned track. Dates for 2025 events were expected to be out by the end of December.

REGALIA

Colin had limited stocks of windscreens left so encouraged everyone to grab a spare before the prices skyrocketed. John Sherman had donated a NZ Austin-Healey cap which, fittingly, made its way to Di-
anne!

**SHOW & TELL**

N/A

FOR SALE OR WANTED

N/A

GENERAL BUSINESS

- On behalf of Bryan Levy, Denis thanked everyone for their support for the recent Make-A-Wish Day – it had raised a whopping \$28K!
- And as Ray had suggested last month, members came out with their favourite Terry Bancroft one-liners!
- Series 3 Episode 3 of Car SOS featured Stirling Moss' Sprite Special (available on ABC iView)



Meeting concluded at 8.35pm.



AUSTIN HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC

ABN 87 630 303 136

PO Box 3011 Rhodes NSW 2138

www.austinhealeynsw.com.au

enquiries@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Notice of 2024 Annual General Meeting

**THE ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING (AGM) OF THE AUSTIN HEALEY OWNERS CLUB (NSW) INC
WILL BE HELD AT STRATHFIELD GOLF CLUB, 52 WEEROONA ROAD, STRATHFIELD NSW,
ON THURSDAY 5 DECEMBER 2024, COMMENCING AT 7:15PM**

Business

- 1 2023 Annual General Meeting Minutes**
- 2 Committee Report**
- 3 Financial Statements**
- 4 Election of Committee Members**
- 5 Invitations to Honorary Membership**

BY ORDER OF THE COMMITTEE

Julie Lee

Julie Lee

Secretary

3 November 2024



Social Report

Dianne Lawlor 0413 873 191

gregorymstrange@gmail.com

Denis Kasza 0407 492 008

deniskasza@gmail.com

The AHOC's October activities began with the Central Coast Chapter's meeting, then the visit to Mt Annan Botanic Gardens, followed by the Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapter's visit to Goulburn Steampunk Victoria Fair.

The month concluded with the Mid-North Coast Chapter's meeting. Read more about these events elsewhere in this month's Flat Chat newsletter.

We have some excellent and exciting events planned for November: the Central Coast Chapter's regular event on Saturday November 2nd, a visit on Sunday 10th to the Zig Zag Railway, followed by afternoon tea at Caroline and Patrick Quinn's home at 3pm that day.

Then on Saturday 16th, the Mid-North Coast Chapter will hold their regular meeting, followed by the Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapter Christmas Catch-up on Wednesday 20th November.

Looking ahead to December, Sydney Car Talk will be held on Sunday 1st Dec, followed by the AGM and monthly meeting on Thursday 5th and then the Central Coast and Mid-North Coast chapter meetings. On Saturday Dec 14th we will have our Christmas Lunch at Sydney Rowers Club, Abbotsford.

A Christmas hamper will be raffled at the Christmas Party with tickets \$5. Proceeds will go to the Beyond Blue charity.

Please bring items to donate to the Christmas hamper, to Dianne Lawlor, at the December general meeting and AGM on Thursday December 5th 2024. Alternately drop them in to Gregory Strange Motor Mechanic, 117 Cleveland St Darlington.

President's Message Cont'

It's important that you get the forms returned prior to the AGM as voting will only be held on the nominations received prior to the meeting and it will be only those positions that have no nominations that will be considered at the AGM.

Future Meeting Venues As you would be aware from last month's Flat Chat, the management of meeting rooms at Strathfield has changed and hiring fees now are charged. While these were to apply from last month, we have been able to remain until the end of the year at no cost.

Event: Zig Zag Heritage Railway
Date: Sunday 10th November 2024
Time: 12.30 steam train excursion, please arrive earlier.
Parking and cafe available. Book tickets in advance
Venue: 840 Chifley Rd, Clarence 2790
Meet Point: McGraths Hill Maccas, 242 Windsor Rd, Vineyard 2765. Meet 9.30am, depart 10am
Afternoon tea 3pm at Caroline and Patrick Quinn's home, "Wongaburra", 116 Warks Hill Rd, Kurrajong Heights
Contact: as above

Event: Illawarra & Southern Highlands Christmas Catchup
Date: Wednesday 20th November
Venue: 6 Pacific Avenue, Werri Beach (Gerrigong)
Time: after 11:30am
Contact: please RSVP to John Thornton 0419 266 284

Event: Central Coast Workshop
Dates: First Saturday of each month, beginning February
Venue: 109 Humphreys Rd, South Kincumber
Contact: Colin Rule 0467 563 523

Event: Mid-North Coast Workshop
Dates: Third Saturday of each month, beginning February
Venue: 79 Barton St, Croki
Time: 9.00 AM-12.00PM (Please register in advance)
Contact: Phil Lorking 0412 392 362
thelorkings@outlook.com

Event: Sydney Car Talk
Date: Sunday 1st December 2024
Time: 8.30 to 11.am
Venue: Mortlake SLSC, 2 Bennet St Mortlake
Parking available for classic cars

Event: Christmas Lunch Party
Date: Saturday December 14th, 2024
Time: 12.30pm
Venue: Sydney Rowers Club, Abbotsford
Cost \$40, payable to AHOC account
Please RSVP on the club's website
Contact: Christine Lyttle 0410 301 373
membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

Many thanks to our members who have suggested and visited alternative venues. It would appear that our days of having to pay to hire a room have now returned and note that the arrangement at Strathfield has probably saved the club about \$3,000 per annum. We hope to be able to finalise our meeting arrangements shortly and let you know when and where we will be meeting in 2025.

Jim Phillips
President

Membership Report

by Christine Lyttle

membership@austinhealeynsw.com.au

A new membership this month is:

Graham Bradshaw from Breakfast Point with a 1964 Triumph Herald as an Associate Member.

We welcome Graham to our club, and hope to meet him soon.

Thank you to the members that have sent changes to their details on the website - these have been updated (or will be updated if you have given a date for change). Please continue to send any changes to your details to the above email.

Don't forget to book the Christmas Party via the website.

Hope to see you soon at an event.

Happy Healeying,
Christine Lyttle

Vale Bill Ritchie

It's sad to pass on the news of the death of Bill Ritchie on 17 October 2024.

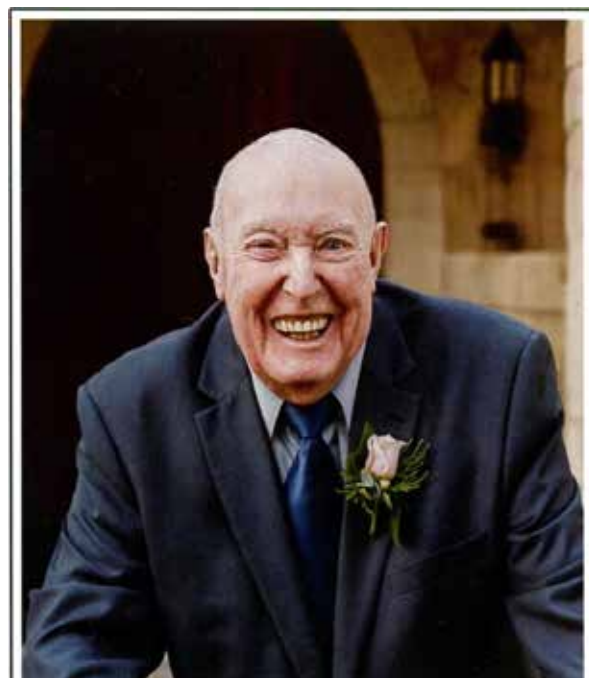
Bill was the proprietor of Olympic Instruments, previously located on the Pacific Highway at Pymble and longer-term members will recall Bill's advertisements that appeared for years when *Flat Chat* was a hardcopy publication.

I recall Bill as being very helpful when the Quinn Austin-Healey was being restored during the 1980s especially with modifying the 100 tach to accept the input from a six-cylinder engine.

When it was back on the road it was clear that the speedo was reading incorrectly due to the higher profile tyres, so a call was made to the ever-helpful Bill who asked me to bring the vehicle to him.

After I arrived, we set off to around the corner not long after the start of Mona Vale Road, where he asked me to stop at a painted white line on the side of the road. He then undid the cable at the back of the speedo and plugged it into a measuring instrument. We then drove until another white line further along the road where it was disconnected.

Back to Olympic Instruments, and the offending speedo was removed and two days later he called,



and I took the car back and he installed it. Perfect! No charge!

After he retired, Bill would gladly help anyone with their instruments. George Goodare also has similar memories of Bill's generous assistance for the cars he has restored throughout the years.

Bill was a brilliant, gentle man and it's sad to hear of his passing.

YOU ARE INVITED TO

RSVP ON WEBSITE

CHRISTMAS LUNCH PARTY

FOOD . DRINKS . FRIENDS

SATURDAY 14 DECEMBER AT 12.30 PM

**Sydney Rowing Club,
Watergrill
613 Great North Road
Abbotsford NSW 2046**

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Contact: Vince Cessario AHOC Member

info@platinumsplash.com.au
13 Widdam Street - Artarmon NSW 2054

Visit to the Australian Botanic Garden Mount Annan Sunday 13 October

Our excursion to Mount Annan went ahead as planned. The morning visit to the Botanic Garden was well worth it with it being in full spring flower and the tour of the Plant Banks was really interesting.

It was good to know that plants and seeds are being preserved and that endangered species are being protected. The Seed Bank and the Herbarium are architecturally very impressive buildings.

A most interesting fact is that there are some plants still being propagated from specimens collected by botanist Joseph Banks during Cook's voyage to Australia in 1770, through the Royal Botanic Gardens.

If there is interest we could put this excursion on again.

Present were:

Greg Strange and Dianne Lawlor - BJ9

Susie Doctor and Denis Kasza - Austin A95



Seed Banks

AHOC Christmas Hamper Raffle



There will be a raffle of a Christmas Hamper at the AHOC's Christmas Lunch Party on Saturday December 14th, to be held at the Sydney Rowers Club, Abbotsford.

Tickets will be \$5, with the proceeds going towards the Beyond Blue Charity.

In the past, the AHOC NSW has supported various charities and at the last committee meeting it was decided to reinstate this.



Donations by club members of hamper items will make up the prize, so we are asking members if they could please contribute by bringing such items to the December general meeting and giving them to Dianne Lawlor, who will be preparing the hamper.

Alternatively, you could drop the goodies in to Dianne at Gregory Strange Motor Mechanic, 117 Cleveland St Darlington.



Historic Vehicle Registration News

If you have a car on Conditional (Historic Vehicle) Registration you should read this.

A whole month has passed by, and I'm pleased to say that I have not received one request for information on how to renew Conditionally Registered vehicles.

What does it mean? Perhaps everyone is full bottle on what to do, as after all the step-by-step instructions have been provided month to month, for heaven knows how long. I have still included the instructions below, because it makes me feel good as I'm certain that not everyone will remember the necessary steps.

There are a couple of relatively minor aspects worth mentioning.

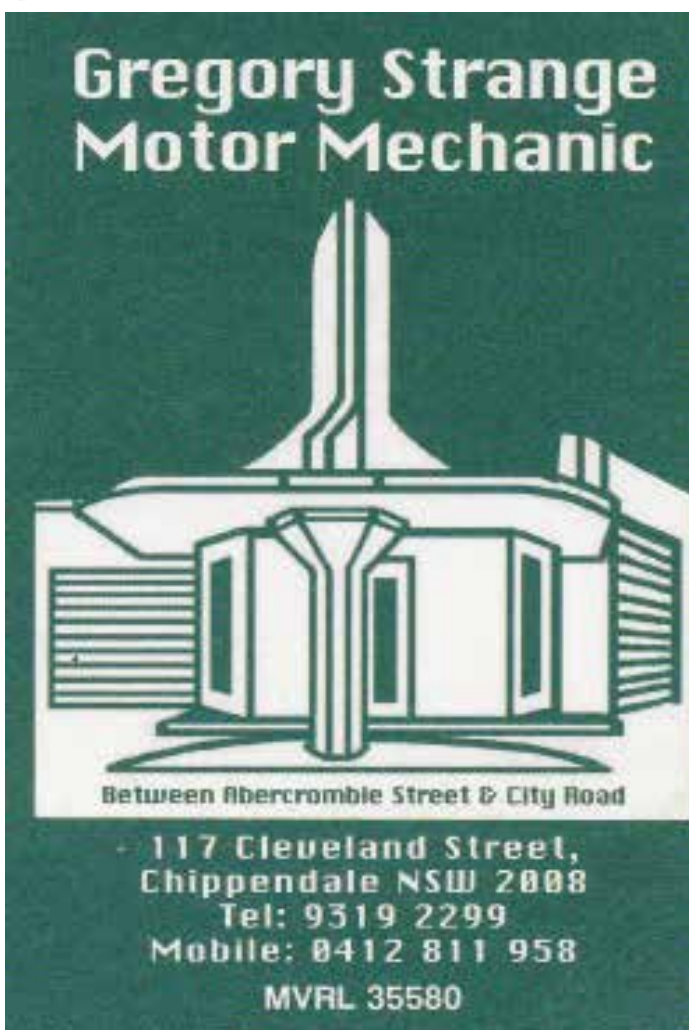
Thank you for including the stamped self-addressed envelope, but does everyone realise that the cost to send a letter within Australia is \$1.50? It's not \$1.20 and it certainly is not a Christmas stamp.

Talking about envelopes, I am sure that many are left over from the Crimea. However not to worry, as I have a big roll of sticky tape on my desk. Plus, please don't try and stuff everything into a itty bitty envelope, splurge on a large envelope to make life easier.

Now on to log books. You can use your car when you wish, but if your journey does not involve a club event make sure you fill it in. It only takes a few seconds. Similarly, if you are on a club event and your journey varies away from the direct route, fill in the log book.

Here they are - the instructions on renewing the Conditional Registration of your car.

- Once you have received the renewal papers from Transport for NSW, arrange for your vehicle to be inspected for roadworthiness by either an Authorised Inspection Station or one of the volunteer AHOC inspection officers. See page 2 of this Flat Chat for their contact details. Remember all vehicles, including Historic vehicles need to be inspected and passed as roadworthy.
- Complete the left-hand side of the "Historic Vehicle Declaration" and post it to me at my home address (See page 2 of this Flat Chat for my address) along with an indication that your car is roadworthy or a copy of the pink slip. Please include a stamped self-addressed envelope. There is no need to send me the registration certificate. Do not post the documents by Registered Post as that just slows down the process as I have to go to the post office to accept a registered postal item.
- Once returned, either go to your local Services NSW office to do the renewal or post to Transport for NSW in Parkes. That address can be found on the registration papers.



**Gregory Strange
Motor Mechanic**

Between Abercrombie Street & City Road

117 Cleveland Street,
Chippendale NSW 2008
Tel: 9319 2299
Mobile: 0412 811 958
MVRL 35580

Don't forget as the stamped self addressed envelope.

cont'from P1

might have been imagined in the past. A chance to travel through time. A subgenre of science fiction that incorporates retro-futuristic technology and aesthetics inspired by industrial steam-powered machinery or an alternative history of the Victorian era or the American frontier, where steam power was mainstream. (Wikipedia)

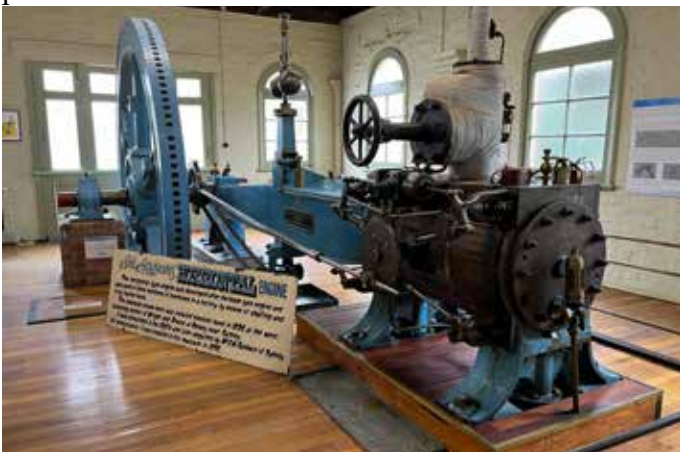
Colin Goldsmith, Gordon and Louise Lynas, John and Judy Sherman, David and Michelle McIntyre, Fran and I made a weekend trip, with Joe Armour and a mate, Drew Hall, attending the Saturday main event.

In colonial NSW, 1880, there was an increasing demand for a reliable supply of clean water.

Becoming operational in January 1886, the Waterworks provided a reticulated water supply to the growing city of Goulburn.



The original 1883 Appleby Bros. steam engine situated inside the pumphouse was one of four installed in pumphouses around NSW. The steam engine is known as a beam engine because of the large overhead rocking beam that transmits motion from the pistons to the cranks.



Also on display in the Waterworks Museum is a Hick, Hargraves & Co Horizontal Engine. This one is the oldest of three surviving engines in the world.

The Steampunk Fair event has been an annual event since 2016 and has a large following of devotees. Steampunk allows the followers to let their imagination run wild for a day as they dress in outlandish Victorian clothing and adorned with long flowing scarves, driving coats, aprons and overalls. Goggles and watches seemed to be an obligatory fashion attachment.



We managed to spend the best part of the day wandering the Fair with many and varied displays, shops and non-stop activities to entertain us.

We ended our day enjoying an evening meal together and chatting well into the evening. A fabulous and entertaining weekend for all.



You can see many more photos on the AHOC website.

John Thornton

AHOC Chapter News

Central Coast Chapter - 5th October 2024



Clear skies started another successful Saturday morning workshop gathering on the Central Coast. A light shower around 11am did not deter the 14 enthusiasts. Numbers were down a little owing to it being a long weekend.

Six Austin-Healeys, a 1963 Falcon Coupe, one Rolls-Royce Silver Shadow, a MGA and a never-say-die Sunbeam Alpine, plus a gaggle of tin tops.

The subject and demo for the morning was reprofiling wiper blades and windscreen maintenance carried out by yours truly. For the wiper blades I used an apparatus to shave a very small section of wiper blade, and re-profile the blade edge on both sides which worked very well.

I used a BJ8 windscreen and a glass cutting compound to remove the wiper blade marks. However, this took much longer than I anticipated. I should've used a bigger buff.

As usual coffee, cookies and cake were on the menu for a great morning tea and thank you for all those folk who contributed. It was nice to see Eric Pearson, a Central Coast MG enthusiast who was invited to show his almost finished MGA, a lovely example of the model.

Bob Sullivan turned up with his 1970 Rolls-Royce Silver Shadow, another lovely example all adding up to very nice display of English classics.

Participants on the day were Julie and Garry Lee Ford Falcon Coupe, Roger Ramsey, Geoff Rudland and Cathy Andrews BJ8, Chris and Mary Lou Jenkins 3000 BT7, Richard Cardew Sunbeam Alpine, Doug Ross, John Wakeling BJ8, Eric Pearson guest MGA, Rob Sullivan guest Rolls-Royce. Colin and Kerrie Rule 100 BN1, 100 BN2 and the Ross Bond Austin-Healey.

November 2nd gathering will be held at Ian and Jennie Richter's home at 20 Fern Road Ourimbah, starting time 9 am. Don't forget to bring a plate to share.

So that is it folks for another Saturday morning workshop report.

Take care and Happy Healeying. Col and Kerrie Rule.

PS. Don't forget to pencil in December 7th. This will be our inaugural Christmas lunch run for the Central Coast Chapter, taking in some of our beautiful and scenic hinterland drives. All AHOC members welcome.



Julie Lee looks closely at Eric Pearson's MGA.



Richard Cardew, Rob Sullivan, Mary Lou and Chris Jenkins Julie Lee, Jeff Rutland and Cathy Andrews, John Wakeling, Roger Ramsay, Eric Pearson, Doug Ross, Garry Lee and Kerrie Rule.

AHOC Mid North Coast Chapter 19th October 2024

Present:-Tony Ash (3000 Mk2), Al & Di Bryson (Sprite Mk1), Glenn Nisbet, Chris & Lyndell Hatch (100), Glenn & Barb Roberson and Phil & Anthea Lorking.

It was great to see another Austin-Healey back on the road after a lengthy period. Following many months of hard work by Chris Hatch, he was able to drive the 100 to the meeting for its first major run. As expected the vehicle performed to perfection.

During the gathering we undertook a quick check for "Toe In/Out", following suspension and chassis work, which was found to be within specifications.

Further work on fitting camber adjustment kits will be carried out in the near future.

Tony, after removing a door trim was having trouble replacing the pin in the door handle assembly (can be difficult with only two hands) The pin was fitted with the assistance of Al Bryson supplying a third hand.

Once again we all needed smoko with a sit down to solve the problems of the world!

Next Meeting - Saturday 16th November (Christmas will be here soon!)

Cheers Phil



AHOC Illawarra & Southern Highlands Chapters

Christmas Catch Up

Wednesday 20th November 2024

Yes, it is that time of year. We have successfully navigated our 2024 events.

For the AHOC's Illawarra and Southern Highlands Chapters' final gathering this year, Fran and I invite all members to join us at our "Pipi Shack" for a casual end of year Christmas get together.

We will provide sausage sizzle, salads, nibbles, tea and coffee, good conversation and cheer.

Address: 6 Pacific Avenue Werri Beach (Gerringong)

Time: Any time after 11:00am on Wednesday 20th November.

Off street parking for a good number of Austin-Healeys.

Response thank you to:

John Thornton

Email: john.thornton2011@outlook.com

Mobile: 0419 266 284



Thank you to member Darren Freeman of Peninsula Sports Car Services for the above photos of cars currently receiving fettling.



FROM THE AHOC Vic PRESIDENT

By now you would have probably seen the booking forms for the 2025 National Rally being hosted by the AHOC of Victoria at the RACV resort at Inverloch, a seaside town 140 kilometres south east of Melbourne. Following the running of the successful West Australian Rally at Geraldton, bookings are now open for the 2025 Rally to members of Australian Austin-Healey clubs.

If you have not been to a National Rally before, you should make the effort and join us at Inverloch, as I am sure you will enjoy yourself.

We have put together a great program of events and the location of the RACV resort is inviting. As well as daytime tours and events, we will gather each evening at the resort for dinner where you will meet new friends and catch up with old ones.

After the final breakfast together, there is the opportunity to travel to the Phillip Island Grand Prix Circuit to witness the first day of action at the largest Historic Motorsport meeting in the Southern Hemisphere.

Once registered for the Rally, we will keep you up to date with developments and events that will be in store for you during your time at the Rally.

Terry Wade





2025 AUSTIN HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY

TUESDAY MARCH 4 TILL FRIDAY MARCH 7

VENUE - RACV RESORT INVERLOCH VICTORIA

ADULTS ATTENDING:

(One person must be a member of a State or National Austin Healey Club!)

1.		2.	
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PERSONAL DETAILS:

Contact street address:			
Suburb:		State:	Postcode:
Telephone:	Home:	Mobile:	
Email address:		State / National Healey Club Membership number:	

Special Dietary requirements (if any):

--

RALLY COSTS:

Adults x	@ \$500.00 ea	TOTAL:	\$
TOTAL AMOUNT DUE:			\$

****Full payment for adult and child tickets must be received by December 31st, 2024.****

**PAYMENT METHODS:**

Payment by: <i>(please highlight)</i>	Cheque:		Direct Deposit:	
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PAYMENT DETAILS:

CHEQUE: Please make all cheques payable to: AHOC of Vic. Inc. Mail to: AHOC of Vic 2025 Rally, 59 Sanders Road, Frankston South, 3199 VIC	BANK TRANSFER (Preferred) : Please use initial and surname as reference: Account: AUSTIN HEALEY OWNERS CLUB OF VIC INC Bank: National Australia Bank BSB: 083-153 Account Number: 12 374 6259
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PLEASE NOTE: RECEIPTS WILL BE ISSUED ON PAYMENT

ENQUIRIES: Email : 2025rally@healeyvic.com.au

HOW WILL YOU TRAVEL?

Are you travelling to the National Rally in an Austin Healey? <i>(please highlight)</i>	Yes	No
If yes, what is the Model No / Type / Colour:		

TERMS AND CONDITIONS:

Refund Policy – The AHOC of Vic Rally Committee takes no responsibility for Accommodation bookings made directly with the RACV Inverloch or any alternative accommodation selected by rally attendees.
 Rally participants must check with their chosen accommodation providers regarding any refund policy offered.

Any refund of Rally Ticket costs will be at the discretion of the AHOC of Vic Rally Committee and no refund request will be considered post 31 January 2025 under any but extreme circumstances.

Disclaimer – All Rally attendees enter and participate in the 2025 National Rally solely at their own risk.
 By lodging a Rally Registration application, attendees release the AHOC of Vic Inc and it's Rally Committee from any and all liability for loss, damage or injury to participants or their vehicles.

Ticket inclusions - Your Rally Ticket includes 3 evening functions including entertainment, meals and drinks (limited to beer, wine and soft drinks.):

- 3 Evening functions at resort
- Various attractions at Port Albert
- 1 lunch
- 1 Farewell Breakfast
- Rally Pack
- A great time with all your Healey Friends!

IN ORDER TO CONFIRM REGISTRATION PLEASE POST OR E MAIL THIS COMPLETED FORM TO:

AHOC of Vic 2025 Rally,
 59 Sanders Road, Frankston South, 3199
 OR : 2025rally@healeyvic.com.au

REGALIA

Regalia order forms will be sent separately.

ACCOMMODATION

See separate accommodation booking form.

Accommodation to be arranged directly with RACV Inverloch



2025 AUSTIN HEALEY NATIONAL RALLY

Tuesday March 4th to Friday March 7th

To be held at RACV Inverloch Resort, Victoria

ACCOMODATION OPTIONS

Premium Ocean View 	Perfect for couples with panoramic views of the Bass Coast and private balcony, ensuite, flat screen TV, microwave, fridge and are located in the main building. All rooms have an allocated parking space.	\$351.30 per night – excluding breakfast
Ocean view 	Ocean View Rooms offer a private balcony, ensuite, flat screen TV, microwave, fridge and are located in the main building. All rooms have an allocated parking space.	\$297.00 per night – excluding breakfast
Deluxe 2 bed cabins 	Scattered throughout the Resort, they feature two bedrooms, one queen bed and one with twin bedding. they have a separate spacious living area, private balcony and one bathroom. Parking at each pod of rooms. 5 to 10 Mins walk to main lodge.	\$258.30 per night /room only(Max 3 guests)



Resort rooms 	Resort rooms are a basic hotel room with bathroom, bar fridge and tea coffee making facilities. These rooms have no deck, no view and are not located in the main building. Bedding configuration can be King or twin. 5 to 10 Mins walk to main lodge.	\$243.00 per night / room only (Max 2 guests)
Standard 2bed villas 	Scattered throughout the resort the Villas feature two spacious bedrooms, both can be either king or twin bedding. The villa has a shared bathroom and toilet as well as a central living area. parking is allocated at each pod of rooms. 5 to 10 Mins walk to main lodge.	\$402.30 per night / room only (Maximum of 4 guests)

Room pricing is based on RACV Member rates by special arrangements with the resort.

Note – more accommodation arrangements MAY be available – enquire directly with the resort for details.

Reservations are to be made on an INDIVIDUAL basis.

- Rates above are room only rates and breakfast is an additional charge per person of \$24.00pd. Guests can add breakfast to their booking upon check in. Alternatively, guests can book breakfast in our Radius restaurant and pay for it on the day.
- Rooms will be held until October 31st, 2024 to allow for your group to book. RACV Inverloch reserve the right to release any rooms not booked by this date and bookings will become subject to availability.
- Rates are valid until the 31st of October 2024 any rooms booked post this date will be subject to available rates at the time of booking.
- Individual reservations will be processed by Reception and not the Conference and events team.



To make a new reservation via a convenient booking link

Follow the following link:

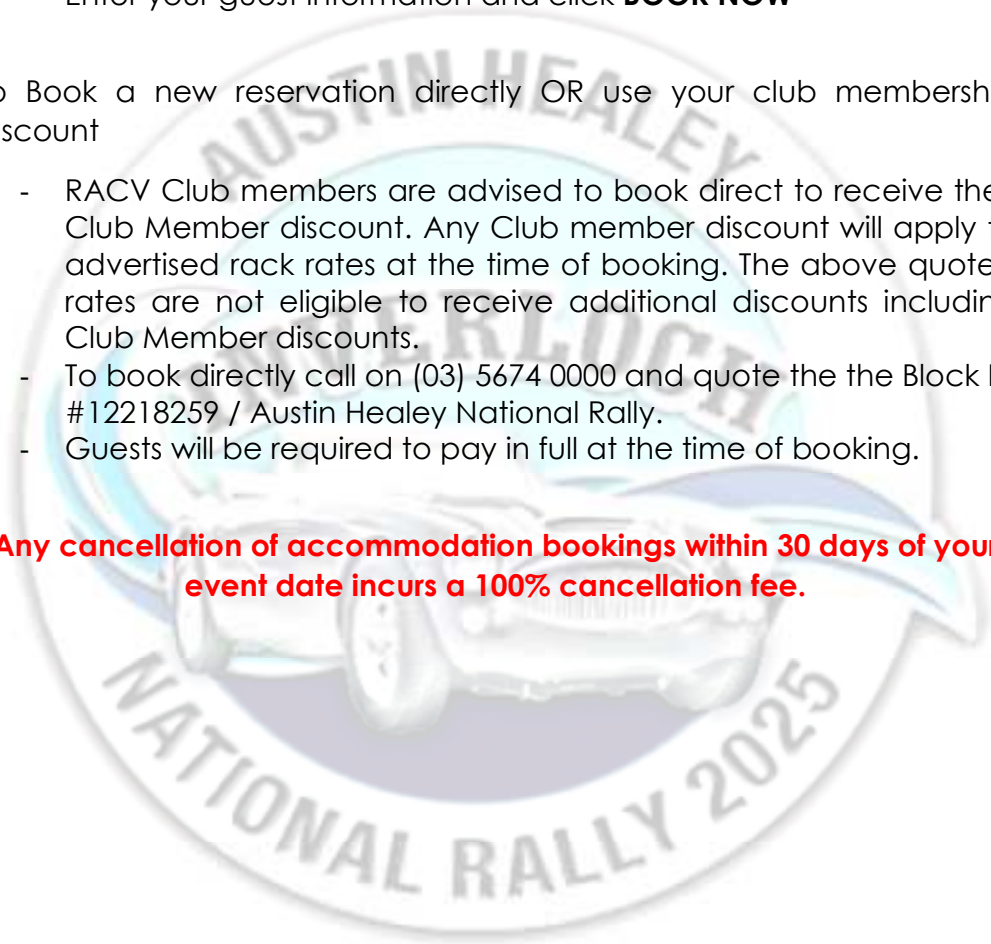
[http://bookings.ihotelier.com/bookings.jsp?groupID=4392528
&hotelID=72449](http://bookings.ihotelier.com/bookings.jsp?groupID=4392528&hotelID=72449)

- Select number of guests and date of stay
- Select your room type
- Enter your guest information and click **BOOK NOW**

To Book a new reservation directly OR use your club membership discount

- RACV Club members are advised to book direct to receive their Club Member discount. Any Club member discount will apply to advertised rack rates at the time of booking. The above quoted rates are not eligible to receive additional discounts including Club Member discounts.
- To book directly call on (03) 5674 0000 and quote the the Block ID #12218259 / Austin Healey National Rally.
- Guests will be required to pay in full at the time of booking.

Any cancellation of accommodation bookings within 30 days of your event date incurs a 100% cancellation fee.





AUSTIN HEALEY



NATIONAL RALLY



Caps \$20 each
Grey, Blue, White

Polo Shirt Sizes:
Ladies – 6 to 26
Mens – Small to 12XL
Caps – one size fits all



Polo Shirts
\$35 each
Grey, Blue, White

ORDER FORM

Polo Shirts: Number, Size/s & Colour/s

eg 1x L14 Blue or 2x M2XL 1Grey 1White

Caps: Number, Colour/s: G B W

Total Amount due:

Name: **Phone:**

Address:

Email:

BANK TRANSFER ONLY: Account Austin Healey Owners Club of Victoria
Bank National Australia Bank BSB 083-153 Account Number 12374 6259
Please reference: Regalia with your initial and surname

RETURN ORDER FORM TO: Reg McNee 3/13 Washington Street, Toorak 3134 or
Email Reg McNee reginaldamcnee@gmail.com
Any questions call Reg McNee on 0434 242 013. or email reginaldamcnee@gmail.com





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Patrick Quinn
"Wongaburra"
116 Warks Hill Road
Kurrajong Heights
NSW 2758

You can give me the drive (&
stamp) at a meeting.



Slow Road to Inverloch - NOT Quite a Charlie's Run

The next National Rally (see preceding pages PQ) will be held from 4 to 7 March 2025 at Victoria's beautiful seaside village of Inverloch. For those of you who want to get there quickly, there are more direct and faster routes. However, this trip is the alternative for those who enjoy visiting a number of towns and having time to 'smell the roses' as they travel in the company of like-minded people.



So, for those intrepid club members who will be taking their lovely Austin-Healeys to Inverloch (and even those miscreants who prefer to travel in a more modern vehicle) we have organised a leisurely wandering route to Inverloch via Shoalhaven, Merimbula and Lakes Entrance before arriving at Inverloch on Monday 3 March. That is one day before the Rally begins, so even if you aren't attending the Rally, you can still travel with us all the way to Inverloch and enjoy a night at the Resort (subject to availability).

Depending on where your journey begins, I am planning to begin with a shortish drive to Shoalhaven on Thursday 27th February where subject to availability we will stay once again at the Shoalhaven Heads Hotel, as everyone enjoyed it on our previous visits. This is an older style hotel/motel, but clean and tidy and it has a restaurant, bar and beer-garden, so we will be able to enjoy a welcoming drink and tasty dinner as we get together at our first stop. Shoalhaven Heads is 170kms (2hrs30) from Sydney and, if you don't know it, the hotel is attractively situated on the banks of the Shoalhaven River.

On Friday 28th February we travel to Merimbula, staying for two nights. That is about 310kms and a four-hour drive. There are a variety of pubs, restaurants and

clubs in town for breakfasts, lunches and dinners.

Sunday 2 March will see us drive to Lakes Entrance, that is about 270kms or three hours driving. We stay there for one night before continuing to Inverloch on Monday 3 March, 254kms or 3hrs10 driving time.

The Rally will begin on the afternoon of Tuesday 4 March, so even if you aren't staying for the Rally perhaps you could take the opportunity to meet some interstate Austin-Healey friends before beginning your journey home later that day.

As there will be some staying for the Rally and some leaving for home on the Tuesday, I haven't organised anything for your return trip. There are a number of options besides returning the way we came, such as: returning to Orbost then heading via Delegate, Cooma and Canberra; continuing to Melbourne and returning via the Hume Highway; or perhaps trekking over the Victorian High Country to Omeo, Bright and on via Albury or Corryong and Tumut. There are plenty of options, so get out your old maps and find an enjoyable route that Google Maps would never offer.

I'm expecting the accommodation costs of this trip to be around \$350 per person on a twin share basis, plus \$150 for the Inverloch resort if you choose to do the complete run. Please contact Gordon at glynas@icloud.com, or call him on 0403 198 343 to book your place.

Once I have a better idea of numbers, I will book motels and finalise the cost.

Happy Healeying

Gordon Lynas



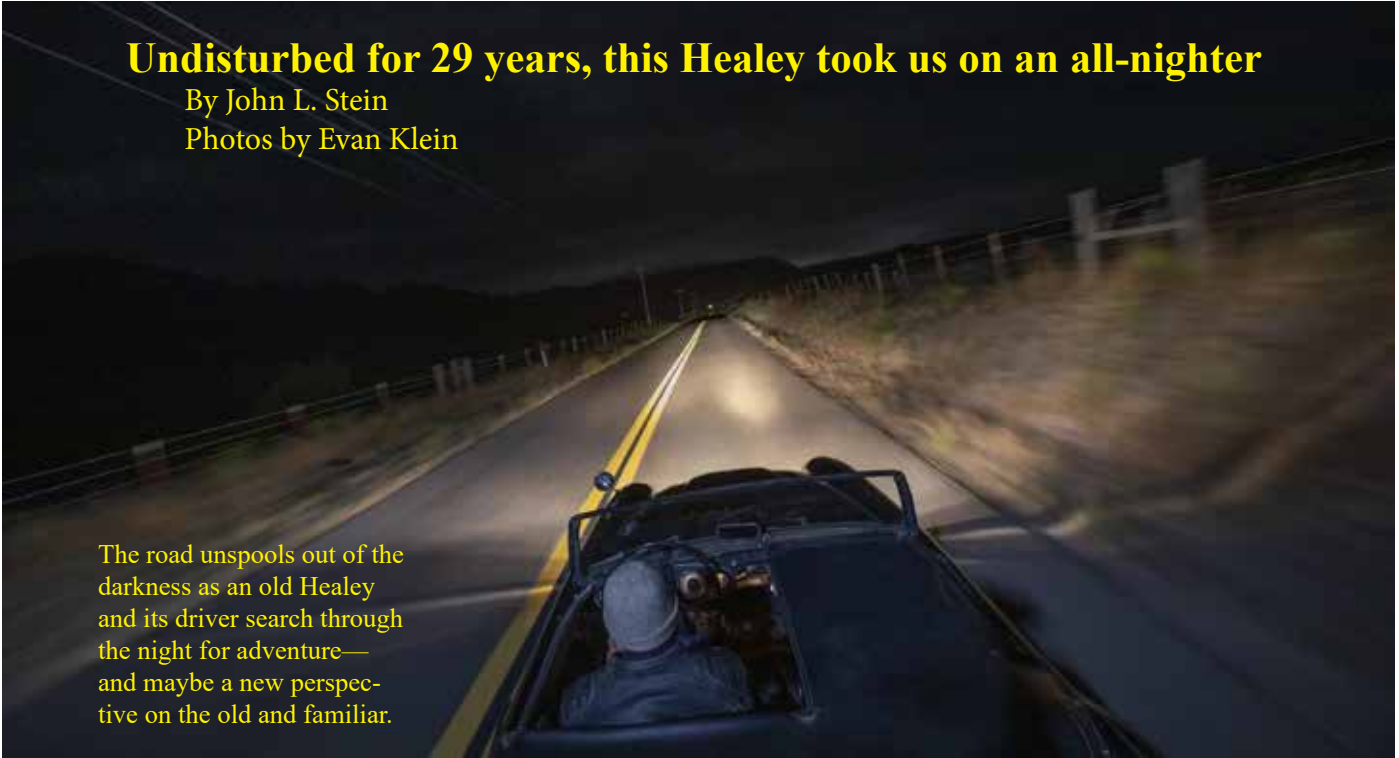
Editor's Note - We are indebted to <https://www.hagerty.com/> for this emotive article about taking a well-worn 100/6 into the Californian hinterland for an all-night drive.

In case you're wondering, Hagerty is a US based motor vehicle insurer that started as a niche insurance agency which has evolved into an automotive lifestyle brand focused on the love of cars and driving. Spend some time exploring the Hagerty website.

Undisturbed for 29 years, this Healey took us on an all-nighter

By John L. Stein

Photos by Evan Klein



The road unspools out of the darkness as an old Healey and its driver search through the night for adventure—and maybe a new perspective on the old and familiar.

At 2:30 a.m., miles from anywhere on a black night in a black Austin-Healey on a black highway with the dark ghost of Joseph Lucas hovering above me like a Harry Potter Dementor, everything looks like an animal. The branches of the valley oaks rushing by overhead, roadside grasses rustling in the breeze, and fence posts streaking past the doorsills all connote images of animals in motion. I felt like a Pliocene man gazing at the constellations and concluding they are actually animal spirits. Suddenly, the surreal turned real as a young white-tailed buck vaulted across the road, mere feet in front of the Healey, its rusty coat and brown eyes the size of demitasse cups, frozen for a dangerous moment in the searing beams of the Marchal driving lights. I slammed hard on the brakes; the pedal pushed eight Ferodo linings against the iron drums, and, mercifully, the 100/6 slowed. Collision averted, but it got me thinking: What am I doing here?

It is a fair question. Weeks after embarking on this bizarre all-night mountain drive in a survivor Austin-Healey 100/6, I'm still grappling with it. Sure, George Mallory famously quipped that Everest

needed climbing "because it's there." But that's too simplistic in this case—and anyway, Mallory's reply was probably meant to dismiss idiot reporters who all wanted to know why. Maybe he really didn't know, any more than I know why I just almost hit a deer when I could be happily asleep in my own bed.

I love my hometown on the central California coast, with its immediate adjacency to coastal mountains and flowing two-lane roads. Over the years, I've ridden and driven them so often that they almost feel like part of my soul. And yet, and yet ... like a marriage, or a weekly menu, or a job routine, or a music playlist, sometimes even things we love begin to feel old. Too familiar. No longer fresh or invigorating.

We can no more invent new roads than cast new planets, so what to do? Maybe upend the clock and drive them at night instead of by day. The added dose of uncertainty, danger, and discomfort nighttime brings can make taking a vintage car highly rewarding in the event of success. And hugely unpleasant in case of failure. En garde!



This garage-find Healey was the call. An amateur rally car in the early 1960s, it was outfitted with aircraft lap belts, the aforementioned driving lights, and a Koni tube-shock conversion up front. It was a well-used old dear when its owner shoved it inside a garage three decades ago and left it to moulder. After buying it, I methodically serviced all systems (electrical, fuel, cooling, brakes, chassis, tires, and clutch) one by one, returning it to fully useful—albeit cosmetically tatty—status.

So, one Saturday night, instead of hitting the hay, I brewed a thermos of coffee, threw some snacks, tools, a flashlight, and gloves into a bag, opened the garage door, and approached the Healey. Trunk opened, I turned the master switch and then hopped into the low bucket seat, put the gearbox in neutral, pulled the choke knob for the twin SUs, turned the key, and pushed the starter button. The 2.6-liter six shook to life and settled into a smooth idle, the metal air filters sucking in cool, dense evening air. Engaging the synchronized second gear before non-synchro reverse stopped the gearbox's input shaft, which made grabbing reverse gear chatter-free. I engaged the clutch, and the Healey backed into the street, angled south, and headed toward the Pacific Ocean and Santa Barbara, to California's historic Stearns Wharf. I had envisioned starting on the pier and finishing there with a quiet breakfast the next morning. In reality, though, jouncing slowly over the hundreds of treated wood beams that make up the pier's surface, swinging a 180, and steeling myself to go proved more worrisome than exciting. It was zero hour—midnight.

As I motored up State Street toward the Santa Barbara Mission, the setting moon revealed La Cumbre Peak to the north, skirted with clouds. It was going



to get real dark, real soon. The last bit of city light vanished as the Healey passed the Mission and turned onto winding Mountain Drive. Bulwarked by a hewn sandstone wall on the right and ancient oaks on the left, the road looked ethereal, mystical, and tunnel-like as the Healey's headlights swept between the rocks and tree branches. A fun little bit of chicanery by day, by night, even these first few miles of my 220-mile loop took on an almost fictional quality—like a scene from Tolkien's *The Lord of the Rings*.

The Healey hummed along in third gear, water temperature at 180, gas gauge pegged, oil pump pushing 40 psi of high-zinc 20W-50 through the old galleys. A curious thing about Big Healeys is that occupants can be at once hot and cold. The driver's footwell is beside the engine block and behind the exhaust headers, and the seat is directly above the muffler. This cocoon is like a pizza oven with a broken thermostat, and it became ever hotter as my drive progressed, especially uphill. And by uphill, I mean really uphill. Over 10 miles, the route climbed nearly 4000 feet. Halfway up, the Healey ploughed into the mist, which made visibility difficult with the standard headlights. I switched on the Marchals for help, although the extra firepower scattered through the cloud droplets, ruining clarity of vision. But they were utterly necessary to negotiate this writhing road at anything more than a crawl. The turns are so sharp, the night was so dark, the drop-offs so steep and the visibility so poor, the first navigational misstep could also have been the last.

High up the mountain, hidden in the inky night, were pockets of parked cars. They were either stargazing or partying, and I suspected the latter. As I passed one group, the faint smell of banana bread wafted

into the Healey cockpit. “That’s odd,” I thought. “Banana bread on a mountain road in the middle of the night?” I expected a different smell, but I carried on, out of the cloud bank and onto a ridge top that led toward the Santa Ynez Valley wine country.



Soon, the charge light in the Healey’s tachometer illuminated, meaning the charging system had faulted. Why, I don’t know. I carried on along the ridge top and down toward the Santa Ynez Valley for 10 or so miles. Even with the driving lights off to save juice, the main headlights lost their accuracy—so much so that seeing anything in the road became hard. With centerlines, roadside markers, and reflective aids nearly nonexistent here, it was clear that only partway through this trip, things were getting dicey. I stopped at a closed ranger station, thankful for its floodlit lot.

Good thing I brought tools. A battery check showed 12.4 volts with the engine running, not the desired 13-plus volts, and revving the engine didn’t build voltage as it should. This suggested either a generator or regulator failure, and it proved to be the cheap re-pop regulator. Pulling off the cover showed one set of points askew, and the unit—aha!—smelled like banana bread. So that was it! I can’t prove it, but I strongly suspect running the Marchal lights through the clouds overworked the regulator, which couldn’t handle the load.



Fortunately, in the trunk was a spare NOS Lucas unit, which I installed by flashlight and feel. It just takes a screwdriver—simple.

It was nearly 2 a.m. when I reached a 24-hour gas station in the Santa Ynez Valley. The oil level was fine, the bugs and mist got cleared from the windshield with some Rain-X and paper towels, and the Big Healey was fueled and good to go.

I’m no Meriwether Lewis or William Clark, but I can imagine the excitement these explorers must’ve felt after crossing the Rockies to enter the West. As the Healey burbled through Santa Ynez and bucolic Los Olivos, then turned north on Foxen Canyon Road into wine country, it felt as if it were similarly breaking free. The environment agreed. Heading north, I was instantly enveloped in one complex rush by the invigorating sensual nature of open motor-ing. The roadside grasses, lightly painted with dew, emitted a marvelous pungency. The steady drone of the iron six breathing through its twin carbs and exhausts was as reassuring as the Wright Whirlwind radial engine that pulled Lindbergh’s Spirit of St. Louis across the Atlantic.

The Marchal driving lights, low mounted as they are, illuminated fine details of the macadam aggregate, as well as details far ahead. The Girling lever-arm rear shocks sent every road ripple, bump, and dip through the seat base and into my spine. The reproduction Michelins telegraphed surprisingly precise road feel through the timeworn steering.



Over the decades, I’ve travelled this route numerous times by day, but never at night. It’s disorienting, as darkness messes with perception. The many small landmarks so easily recognized by day are easily missed at night, and as a result, that sense of

knowing where I am was largely absent. That is, unless these landmarks are unique: a deep drainage swale; a left-right dogleg bisecting two farms; an old windmill. I made a hard right onto Tepusquet Road, where the Healey engine droned loudly on overrun, like Lance Macklin's Healey 100S braking for the Mulsanne Corner at Le Mans. All appeared suddenly in the 100/6's four headlights, like visages in a run-away dream sequence I couldn't control.

Tepusquet is animal country. Joining Santa Ynez Valley and the Cuyama Valley, the road was created the old-fashioned way, by following contour lines within the canyon. Its remote location, dense foliage, and water in low-lying areas are ripe for native fauna, none of which could possibly be expecting a black Austin-Healey on a black night to infiltrate their space. This included the buck and, farther along, a pair of barn owls, swooping between oaks and low over the road. It also included mice, a coyote pup, and a bobcat, startled by the headlights and running ahead of the Healey on the narrow road. I brake for bobcats! They're native to central California, but I'd never seen one until tonight. It broke hard right into the brush and was gone.



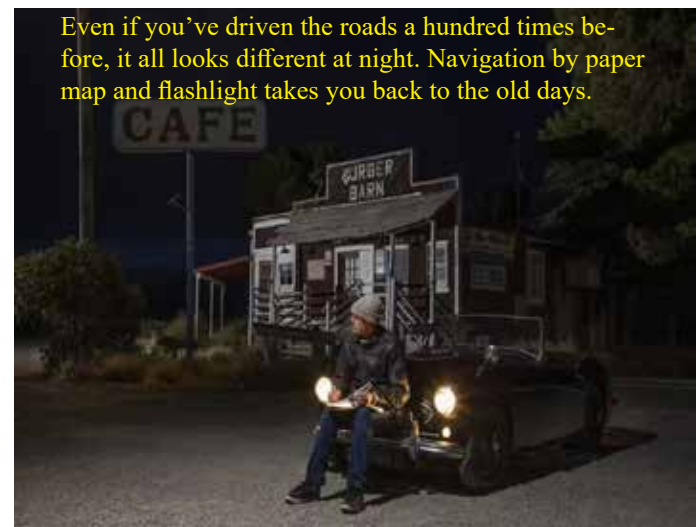
It was probably 3 a.m. by now, maybe later. But the Healey doesn't have a clock, and I didn't bother to check my phone. Who cares, anyway? That's the beauty of being out all night. It's your train and your train schedule. The roadster hummed onward, and downward, through Tepusquet Canyon. Here the walls seemed to close in, and it got steeper and creepier as the oaks reached even more menacingly over the road.

"It's hard to leave when you can't find the door," sang Joe Walsh. Well, the same might be said for

corner apexes when you can't see the exits. There's a section of Tepusquet Road that winds down and around, and around and down, like a series of Laguna Seca corkscrews. The Healey's balky steering, rife with friction, and its simple suspension made this a mental and physical workout. A prang here would have involved a centuries-old immovable oak.

This was getting to be incredible, as every corner brought new criteria to interpret, manage, and then leave in the mirrors. It happens quickly in the dark; if you're jumpy, a nighttime drive like this might make you jumpier. But it will also improve you.

Something loomed ahead that was Not Good. It was a sign, both literal and figurative. It said, "Road Closed 10 Miles Ahead." I was miles and hours into this route, and it was now seriously late at night. I drove on, figuring that it was a daytime warning—but true to the signage, more serious-looking "Road Closed" signs and concrete barriers appeared on cue. Full stop.



Even if you've driven the roads a hundred times before, it all looks different at night. Navigation by paper map and flashlight takes you back to the old days.

So, what to do? Tire tracks on the dirt shoulder indicated vehicles had bypassed the blockade. That was promising, but if rough road lay ahead, the Healey and its 5 inches of ground clearance would not an adroit Mars rover make. I shut down, zipped my jacket closed, grasped the flashlight, and walked ahead.

Every minute in the pitch black at the bottom of this remote canyon felt like an hour. The dark-adapted eye is a pretty good tool, especially peripherally. Ears are OK, too, if they're not ringing like mine were. The nose—well, we're not bloodhounds, are we? So, while padding along in the night, I was keen



to sense what was in the woods. My mind raced through possibilities, such as mountain lions, boars, black bears—even Jack the Ripper. Nearest I could tell, though, there was actually nothing happening—not so much as the creak of a twig or rustle of a leaf, not a yip nor a growl nor a trill from any animal. And no fiery pagan rituals.

But there was indeed a washout, around which ran a rudimentary one-lane bypass that looked plausibly navigable. I returned to the Healey, restarted it, and bounced my way past the washout, eventually rejoining solid asphalt. As low as they were, the Big Healey 3000s similarly got it done at the Alpine Rally in 1961 and 1962—albeit with skid plates.



Having committed my crime, I covered the last few miles of Tepusquet Road until it intersected State Route 166, linking coastal Santa Maria with the famous Grapevine. As in, the Grapevine in the song “Hot Rod Lincoln:” “We was drivin’ up Grapevine Hill/Passing cars like they was standing still.” Turning right there, the 100/6 and I settled into a boring 36 miles through the darkness to little New Cuyama, population 517. Flipping the dash-mounted overdrive switch dropped the revs to 2700, and the Healey booked along happily at 60 mph. The wind was really loud, it was a beautiful night and it was fairly chilly in the airflow, but my feet were roasting below decks.

Four o’clock in the frigging morning, here was the tumbleweed town. Thankfully, the old gas station, though dingy and windblown, features 24-hour self-service. A tank of premium and a quick calculation showed that the Healey’s fuel economy improved to 17 mpg on the run through wine country, down the long canyon and along the State Route 166

corridor. That’s more like it. And then, was it my ringing ears, or were distant roosters crowing? With the dark eastern hills silhouetted against the faintest hint of gray sky, dawn was on its way and the roosters’ walnut brains knew it before mine did. Monday would welcome me not with coffee and eggs Benedict on Stearns Wharf but with hunger pangs in Cuyama Valley.

It is astounding how fast the night flew by. It seemed like only moments ago that I made my start above the lapping Pacific waves, and now it was nearly dawn in this remote valley. But weirdly, I wasn’t tired; maybe my own rooster brain was activating for the new day.

Tank filled, tires and oil checked, the Healey re-joined State Route 166, again heading east. It was almost light enough to see now, and the engine thrummed along faithfully, its overdrive alive, the oil pressure and water temps feeling fine. All was right in this Big Healey’s world. At least, until the sun finally peeked above the peaks, and the pastel sky brought not warmth but more biting cold. Now, not even the boiling footwell inside the Healey could blast enough BTUs to keep my upper body warm. I was wearing heavy jeans, a T-shirt under a flannel shirt, a leather jacket, motorcycle gloves, and a beanie, but I was still bloody cold.

A final challenge loomed ahead—the north side of the Transverse Ranges separating bleak Cuyama Valley from artsy Ojai. It would be 5 steep miles up and over 5160-foot Pine Mountain Summit before I could rejoice in a relaxing 30-mile descent into Ojai, then 18 more miles downhill to Ventura and the Pacific. It promised to be a lovely finish—if the Healey and I could make the grade. Rated at 102–117 horsepower when new, the 100/6 was hardly a performance darling in period, and years and miles have surely dropped this example’s vigor further. As a result, third gear, with overdrive off, was the right choice for scaling this last topographical test.

This is a short odyssey, I’ll admit, compared to the 24 Heures du Mans or the Baja 1000. Yet, overnight in the black bucket seat of a black Healey through the black of night feels pretty defiant, as the 9-to-5 world goes. In the end, the lazy glide path back into daytime, and the leisurely coast down to the ocean,



Before he knows it, the dawn is breaking over the distant hills. The night flew by so fast, both literally and figuratively, but our man isn't even tired. The adrenaline of a night drive in an old car will do that to you.

felt very much like rejoining a world left behind. When I intersected Highway 101, it was all still there, with the morning commuters, surfers, and shorebirds barely giving the Healey a glance. Why should they? It was just a dirty old car parked at the beach, with its driver gazing vacantly offshore, looking for answers.

So, what's this all mean, anyway? Sadly, no apparitions appeared above the waves to let me know. But I can offer this: Driving all night, even on well-known roads, will add new excitement to your classic-car routine. It's like diving into a rabbit hole, exploring all that can possibly be sensed in the dark,

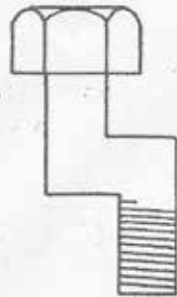
then popping back into the sunlight, dazed, stunned, and yearning for meaning. Which, in my case, mainly includes wishing I'd brought along breakfast and a surfboard. How's that for deep? Well, by this point, I had been up 26 hours and had an hour's drive home ahead of me.

Driving alongside the Pacific in a dirt-streaked old Healey contrasting with the polished Priuses and Teslas of the workaday crowd is my kind of protest. Even so, I'll admit, the world seemed welcoming instead of forbidding—and also bright, colorful, and fun. It's no wonder we're such creatures of daytime. But now, the night's all right with me.



A Real Gift for the Home Restorer

I'm sure we all have had the need for the below, which are now available from wherever you obtain your fasteners.



For mismatched holes.



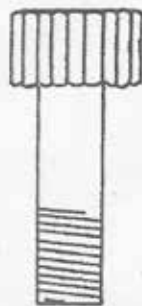
For holes too near the edge.



For holes countersunk too deep.



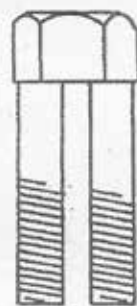
For holes drilled crooked.



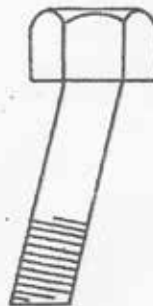
Corrugated for Stilson's Multi Grips etc.



For holes with countersink on wrong side.



Binocular bolt for double drilled holes.



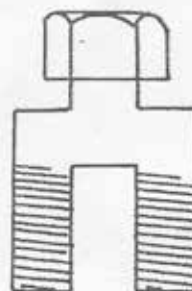
For holes not square.



For tapered holes.



For re-drilled holes that still don't match.



For double countersunk holes.

cx87



FOR SALE



100 BN1 Left hand rear guard in good condition. Has been sand blasted and undercoated. Repair front dogleg - \$400.00



100/6 bonnet in good condition. Has been sand blasted and undercoated - \$500.00



Please call Bryn on (02) 4965 7137, 0404 031 137 or bhbav@optusnet.com.au



Austin-Healey Windscreens



The AHOC is pleased to announce that the club has taken delivery of a new batch of Austin-Healey replacement windcreens.



There are five of each, namely 100, 100/6 – 3000 Roadster and BJ7-BJ8. They are extremely well priced at \$280 each, irrespective of the model.



If interested please contact Colin Rule on 0467 563 523.

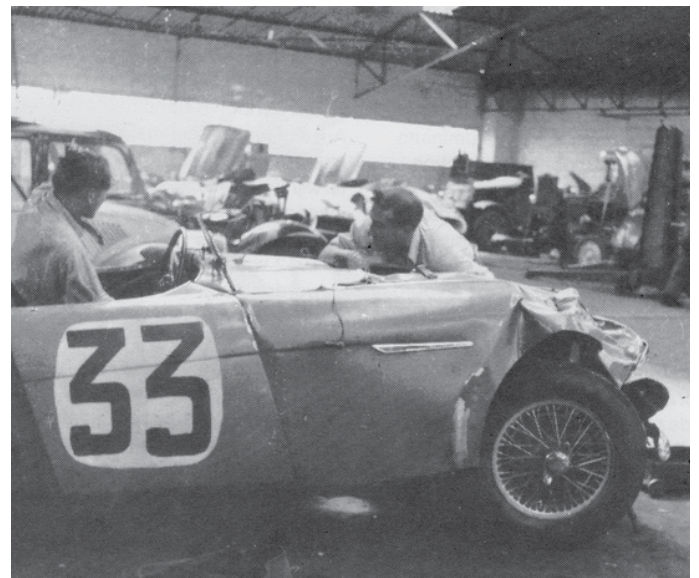
Your Last Page



Spot the Austin-Healey.

Not that difficult.

An interesting photo taken in Ontario, Canada in 1969.



Left - Works Rally 3000s leaving for the 1960 Liege-Rome-Liege. Pat Moss sitting in the rear car who would go on to win. Above - Not all cars arrived back in pristine condition.

Monthly Meetings - Zoom ID 980 9019 7648 Passcode 336164

**We meet on the first Thursday of the month at Strathfield Golf Club
Weeroona Rd, Strathfield. Starting at 7.30pm or enjoy dinner from 5.30pm**